

6.7 The Bat!

This one isn't freeware, but too many people swear by it—that's why we're mentioning it here. It costs \$35 (Rs 1,400), so let's take a look at whether it's worth that much. The download location is <http://www.ritlabs.com/en/products/thebat/download.php> (The Bat! v3.99.29 Home Edition).

This is one program with a lot of features, and for a full explanation, we'd recommend you visit <http://www.ritlabs.com/en/products/thebat/features.php>. In what follows, we'll only describe the outstanding features.

So well, when you install The Bat!, you get this rather unconventional, professional-looking message:

The message (note that this dialog appears before the program has even started up) says that regular backups are important. It offers to, basically, package



The Bat! means business! everything in the mail program into one single file, on a regular basis. You know where the file is, so you could copy it to another hard disk or to optical disc when you feel like. If anything goes wrong—you need to reinstall Windows, or your hard disk crashes, or whatever—all you need is that one file to be back in business.

As you'd expect, you can import your mail from OE or from one of several other programs. You'll notice, when you right-click a message, that there is a rich variety of options: deal with the attachments, Park or Un-park it (explained later), assign it a Colour Group (explained later), and more.

As an example of how comprehensive in terms of mail management features the program is, the filters aren't built up condition-by-condition as in Outlook or OE. It's different, and it's likely